

MEETING 7

WRITING AN ESSAY

Egyptian hieroglyphs

An **essay** is a piece of writing several paragraphs long. It is about one topic, just as a paragraph is. However, because the topic of an essay is too complex to discuss in one paragraph, you need to divide it into several paragraphs, one for each major point. Then you need to tie the paragraphs together by adding an introduction and a conclusion.

Writing an essay is no more difficult than writing a paragraph except that an essay is longer. The principles of organization are the same for both, so if you can write a good paragraph, you can write a good essay.

The Three Parts of an Essay

An essay has three main parts: an **introduction** (introductory paragraph), a **body** (at least one, but usually two or more paragraphs), and a **conclusion** (concluding paragraph).

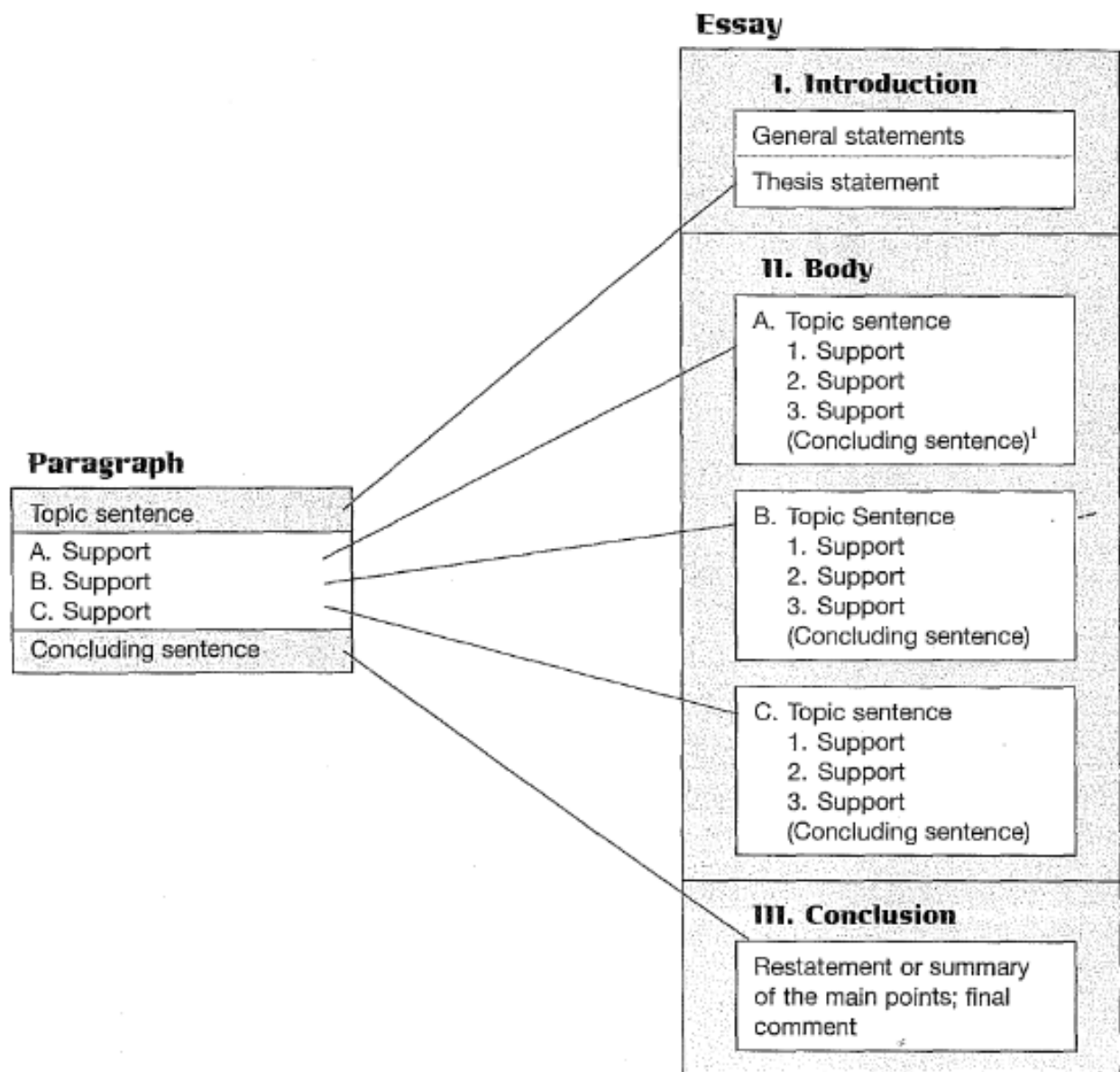
The following chart shows you how the parts of a paragraph correspond to the parts of an essay.

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An essay **introduction** consists of two parts: a few general statements to attract your reader's attention and a **thesis statement** to state the main idea of the essay. A thesis statement for an essay is like a topic sentence for a paragraph: It names the specific topic and gives the reader a general idea of the contents of the essay. The **body** consists of one or more paragraphs. Each paragraph develops a subdivision of the topic, so the number of paragraphs in the body will vary with the number of subdivisions or subtopics. The **conclusion**, like the concluding sentence in a paragraph, is a summary or review of the main points discussed in the body.

An essay has **unity** and **coherence**, just as a paragraph does. **Transition signals** and the **repetition of key nouns** link the paragraphs into a cohesive whole.

¹Concluding sentences for body paragraphs in an essay are not always necessary, especially when the ideas in consecutive paragraphs are closely related.



The Advantages and Disadvantages of Social Media for Students

In the modern digital age, social media plays a significant role in the lives of students. Platforms such as Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, and WhatsApp are used daily for communication, entertainment, and learning. Social media has changed the way students interact with information and with one another. However, while social media offers many advantages in education and personal development, it also brings several disadvantages that can affect students negatively. This essay will discuss both the benefits and drawbacks of social media for students.

To begin with, one of the major advantages of social media is that it provides easy access to information and learning resources. Students can watch educational videos, join study groups, and follow online tutorials that help them understand their subjects better. In addition, social media allows students to collaborate and communicate with peers and teachers outside the classroom. For example, they can share notes, ask questions, or discuss assignments in group chats. Furthermore, social media helps students develop digital literacy skills, which are essential for their future careers in a technology-driven world. In short,

Another advantage of social media is its ability to connect students globally. Through online platforms, students can make friends from different countries and learn about other cultures. This promotes cultural awareness and open-mindedness, which are important qualities in today's interconnected world. Social media can also serve as a place for students to express creativity, share opinions, and participate in social causes, which helps them build confidence and social responsibility. In other words,

On the other hand, social media also has several disadvantages that can negatively influence students' academic and personal lives. Firstly, excessive use of social media often leads to distraction and procrastination, causing students to spend less time studying. Secondly, it may contribute to mental health problems, such as anxiety or low self-esteem, especially when students compare themselves to others online. Moreover, social media exposes students to cyberbullying and privacy risks, which can affect their emotional well-being and sense of security.

In conclusion, social media has both positive and negative effects on students. It can be a valuable tool for learning, communication, and global connection if used properly. However, it can also cause serious problems when used irresponsibly or excessively. Therefore, students should learn to use social media wisely and in moderation, balancing their academic responsibilities with their online activities. By doing so, they can enjoy the benefits of social media while minimizing its harmful effects.

Essential Strategies for Computer Maintenance

The computer has fundamentally reshaped the landscape of modern life, acting as the indispensable engine for everything from global commerce and education to personal communication. Given its central role, maintaining its efficiency and longevity is not merely a technical chore but a critical necessity. Over time, both hardware and software inevitably suffer degradation, leading to sluggish performance, frustrating errors, and potential data loss. Therefore, effective computer maintenance hinges on a triad of crucial, interlinked strategies: proactive software management, diligent hardware care, and robust security practices.

The first essential pillar of maintenance involves diligent software management, focusing on optimizing the digital environment to ensure smooth operation. A primary step in this process is ensuring all operating systems and applications are consistently updated. These updates often contain vital security patches and performance improvements that resolve existing bugs and enhance stability. Equally important is routine digital decluttering. Users should regularly uninstall applications that are no longer in use, delete temporary files, and clear out excessive browser cache. Furthermore, utilizing built-in tools for disk cleaning or defragmentation (for traditional HDDs) prevents fragmented data from unnecessarily slowing down file access times. By keeping the digital landscape tidy and current, users significantly reduce system strain and maximize processing speed.

In addition to digital care, the second strategy addresses the physical components, recognizing that hardware longevity depends heavily on the user's diligent attention. The greatest threat to computer hardware is excessive heat, usually caused by dust accumulation. Regular, careful cleaning of cooling fans, heat sinks, and ventilation ports is non-negotiable for preventing overheating, which can irreversibly damage components like the CPU and GPU. This physical maintenance should extend to checking external connections, ensuring all cables (power, monitor, peripherals) are securely fastened, and, for laptop users, practicing proper battery health management to maximize its life cycle. Maintaining a clean physical environment directly translates to reliable thermal performance and reduced risk of premature hardware failure.

The third and arguably most critical element of a holistic maintenance plan is the implementation of robust security practices to safeguard data integrity and system health. The proliferation of sophisticated malware and phishing attempts makes a strong defence indispensable. This defence must include the installation and regular updating of reputable anti-virus and anti-malware software, complemented by scheduled full-system scans. However, technology alone is insufficient; user vigilance is paramount. Practicing safe browsing habits, exercising extreme caution with suspicious emails or unsolicited file downloads, and routinely backing up essential data to an external drive or cloud service form a multilayered shield. This security-focused approach protects the computer not just from performance issues but from catastrophic compromise.

In conclusion, the strategies for maintaining a computer are comprehensive, requiring a balanced effort across both the digital and physical domains. The combination of proactive software management, meticulous hardware cleanliness, and constant vigilance through security practices ensures that the investment in

technology continues to pay dividends. By adhering to this essential triad of maintenance strategies, users transform their devices from fragile tools prone to obsolescence into reliable, high-performance instruments that can consistently meet the demands of the digital age.

“Effective Strategies for Computer Maintenance”

Proper computer maintenance is essential to ensure optimal performance, extend device lifespan, and prevent system failures. As computers are used daily for work, education, and communication, they are at high risk of hardware damage, system crashes, and security threats if not maintained regularly. Therefore, effective computer maintenance strategies—such as performing system cleaning, maintaining hardware components, and enhancing security—are necessary to keep computers running efficiently and securely.

One effective strategy for maintaining computers is performing regular system cleaning. First, users should routinely delete unnecessary files and uninstall unused programs to free up storage space and enhance system speed. Second, running disk cleanup and defragmentation tools can optimize hard drive performance. Third, keeping the operating system and software updated ensures system stability and prevents performance issues. In short, system cleaning is an essential step to improve computer efficiency and avoid slow performance.

Another key strategy is maintaining the computer's hardware components. Regularly cleaning dust from the CPU, keyboard, and ventilation systems helps prevent overheating and physical damage. Additionally, checking hardware components, such as RAM and hard drives, can reduce the risk of sudden system failures. Lastly, providing a stable electrical power source with a UPS or surge protector can protect hardware from voltage spikes. Thus, proper hardware maintenance ensures long-lasting and reliable computer performance.

Enhancing system security is also crucial for effective computer maintenance. Installing antivirus software and performing regular scans protects the computer from malware and cyberattacks. In addition, enabling firewalls and strong passwords helps prevent unauthorized access. Finally, avoiding suspicious downloads and unsafe websites reduces the risk of data theft and system infection. Therefore, strengthening security measures can protect both the computer and the user's data from digital threats.

In conclusion, proper computer maintenance plays a vital role in keeping systems fast, safe, and durable. By regularly performing system cleaning, maintaining hardware components, and enhancing security, users can prevent common computer problems and extend the device's lifespan. With consistent maintenance, computers will remain reliable tools that support daily activities effectively and efficiently.

